

Millions may lose health coverage

Work requirements are expected to have a seismic effect on Medi-Cal recipients.

By LAURA J. NELSON

The nation's first mandated work requirement for Medicaid recipients, approved by the Republican-led Congress and signed by President Trump, is expected to have a seismic effect in California.

One estimate from state health officials suggests that as many as 3.4 million people could lose their insurance through what Gov. Gavin Newsom calls the “labyrinth of manual verification,” which involves Medi-Cal recipients proving every six months that they are working, going to school or volunteering at least 80 hours per month.

“It’s going to be much harder to stay insured,” said Martha Santana-Chin, the head of L.A. Care Health Plan, a publicly operated health plan that serves about 2.3 million Medi-Cal patients in Los Angeles County.

She said that as many as 1 million people, or about 20% to 40% of its members, could lose their coverage.

The work requirement will be the first imposed nationwide in the six-decade history of Medicaid, the program that provides free and subsidized health insurance to disabled and low-income Americans.

It’s relatively uncharted territory, and it’s not yet clear how the rules will shake out for the 5.1 million people in California who will be required to prove that they are working in order to qualify for Medi-Cal, the state’s version of Medicaid.

After the 2026 midterm elections, millions of healthy adults will be required to prove every six months that they meet the work requirement in order to qualify for Medicaid. The rule applies to those whose income is between 100% and 138% of the federal poverty limit, a group that became eligible for Medicaid when the program was expanded under the Affordable Care Act.

The new mandate spells out other exceptions, including for people who are pregnant, in addition treatment or caring for children under 14.

Democrats have long argued that the program is a lifeline for millions of low-income Californians. [See Medi-Cal, A14]



ELIZABETH DANIELS J. Paul Getty Trust



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RICARDO DEARATANHA Los Angeles Times

BLACK heritage sites receiving landmark status include St. Elmo Village, clockwise from top left, StylesVille Barbershop & Beauty Salon and Jewel’s Catch One.

Six Black heritage sites named L.A. monuments

The Tom and Ethel Bradley house is among the buildings recognized for their cultural significance

By JESSICA GELT

When Tom and Ethel Bradley moved with their two young daughters into a modest three-bedroom home in Leimert Park in 1950, Black people were restricted from buying houses in the neighborhood. The Bradleys had to purchase the home through a white buyer likely affiliated with the American Civil Liberties Union, recalled their oldest daughter, Lorraine Bradley, who was almost 7 years old at the time.

“It was the very first time that a Black family moved into Leimert Park,” said Lorraine, explaining the immediate historic significance of the home, and adding that her parents were brave people who believed integration was essential to equality. “My parents understood the implications of that. They were willing to sacrifice themselves in many regards.”

For the first year, white children on the street wouldn’t play with Lorraine or her 5-year-old sister, but that slowly changed and the family became accepted in the neighborhood. It helped that Tom was a police officer, Lorraine said.

Tom and Ethel explained to their children that, “un-

less people understood and lived with you, they would only look at you racially and not as a person,” Lorraine said.

The 1,282-square-foot home — where the Bradleys lived until 1977, when Tom was reelected to a second term as the first Black mayor of Los Angeles and moved the family into the 10,000-square-foot Getty House — is among six buildings of deep importance to Black heritage in L.A. that have been designated Historic-Cultural Monuments as part of a project led by the Getty in collaboration with the City of Los Angeles’ Office of

[See Monuments, A8]

New voting maps could put these lawmakers at risk

Redrawn California districts could shift up to five GOP seats to Democratic column.

By LAURA J. NELSON

California Democrats and Texas Republicans are in an old-fashioned standoff, threatening to redraw their congressional maps in an attempt to sway the outcome of the 2026 midterm elections.

Caught in the middle are a handful of California Republicans, from relative newcomers to seasoned veterans, who represent pockets of the state from the U.S.-Mexico border to the remote forests in the northeast corner.

The Texas GOP is pushing, at the behest of President Trump, to net five additional seats for congressional Republicans, who hold the U.S. House of Representatives by a razor-thin margin. In response, Gov. Gavin Newsom has said California will push back with a

map that would increase the number of Democrats the state sends to Washington.

“The idea that the president of the United States says he’s entitled to five seats should sicken everybody,” Newsom said at a news conference Thursday. “There’s nothing normal about that and anyone who says it’s not surprising is normalizing it. That’s shocking.”

The California gerrymandering plan taking shape behind closed doors would increase the Democratic Party’s dominance in the Golden State, adding as many as five congressional districts favorable to Democrats, according to a draft map reviewed by The Times. If the Democrats succeed, those changes could leave Republicans with four of the state’s 52 House seats — down from the current roster of nine.

California’s districts are typically drawn once per decade by an independent commission. Newsom is pushing to put a new map tailored to favor Democrats in front of voters Nov. 4. That [See Redistricting, A8]

Trump’s broad tariffs take effect

President anticipates unprecedented growth as economic pain begins to emerge.

By JOSH BOAK

WASHINGTON — President Trump began imposing higher import taxes on dozens of countries Thursday, just as the economic fallout of his months-long tariff threats has begun to create visible damage to the U.S. economy.

Just after midnight, goods from more than 60 countries and the European Union became subject to tariff rates of 10% or higher. Products from the EU, Japan and South Korea are taxed at 15%, while imports from Taiwan, Vietnam and Bangladesh are taxed at 20%. Trump also expects the EU, Japan and South Korea to invest hundreds of billions of dollars in the U.S.

“I think the growth is going to be unprecedented,” he said Wednesday. He said the U.S. was “taking in hun-

dreds of billions of dollars in tariffs,” but did not provide a specific figure for revenues because “we don’t even know what the final number is” regarding the rates.

Despite the uncertainty, the White House is confident that the onset of his tariffs will provide clarity about the path for the world’s largest economy. Now that companies understand the direction the U.S. is headed, the Republican administration believes it can ramp up new investments and jump-start hiring in ways that can rebalance America as a manufacturing power.

So far, however, there are signs of self-inflicted wounds to the U.S. as companies and consumers brace for the repercussions of the new taxes.

Hiring began to stall, inflationary pressures crept upward and home values in key markets started to decline after the initial tariff rollout in April, said John Silvia, chief executive of Dynamic Economic Strategy.

“A less productive economy requires fewer workers,” [See Tariffs, A12]

An early start for state’s fire season

New study shows that since 1990, the period comes up to 2 months sooner in areas.

By CORINNE PURTILL

You are not imagining it. Fire season in California is indeed starting earlier and lasting longer in virtually every region of California than it did two decades ago, researchers have found, thanks largely to human-caused climate change.

In the Sierra Nevada, fire season starts about 24 days earlier than it did in the early 1990s. In the Northern Basin and Range region, which runs along the northernmost border with Nevada, it’s 31 days earlier.

And in the Cascade Range, which runs into Oregon, fire season now begins 46 days earlier than it once did, according to a study published this week in the journal Science Advances.

“Anecdotally, those of us living here have this sense that it’s been happening

sooner,” said Amanda Fencel, a Berkeley-based water specialist who directs climate science for the climate and energy program at the Union of Concerned Scientists and was not directly involved with the research. “This is really an important study to quantify just how soon and where it is shifting, and to what extent.”

Although the number of people living in California has grown by roughly 27% since the early 1990s, human-ignited fires have dropped significantly during that time, enabling the researchers to rule out human-caused blazes as the source of the additional burn days.

Rather, the most significant factors showing fire season forward are climate-related, they found: an earlier snowmelt and increased drying of soils and flammable vegetation as average temperatures rise.

“The main driver is the climate and meteorological conditions,” said Gavin D. Madakumbura, a UCLA postdoctoral researcher and [See Season, A14]

ICE arrests plummet in L.A., data show

By JENNY JARVIE

Arrests of undocumented immigrants have dropped significantly across the Los Angeles region two months after the Trump administration launched its aggressive mass deportation operation, according to new figures released by the Department of Homeland Security.

Federal authorities told The Times on July 8 that federal agents had arrested

2,792 undocumented immigrants in the seven counties in and around L.A. since June 6. Homeland Security updated that number on Wednesday, indicating that fewer than 1,400 immigrants have been arrested in the region in the last month.

“Since June 6, 2025, ICE and CBP have made a total of 4,163 arrests in the Los Angeles area,” Homeland Security spokesperson Tricia McLaughlin said in a statement to The Times, referring to Immigration and Customs

Enforcement and Customs and Border Protection agents.

Although 1,371 arrests across the L.A. region since July 8 is still a much higher figure than any recent month before June, it represents a notable drop from the 2,792 arrests during the previous month.

The new figures confirm what many immigration experts suspected: The Trump administration’s immigration agenda in L.A. has faltered since federal courts

blocked federal agents from arresting people without probable cause to believe they are in the U.S. illegally.

McLaughlin said Wednesday that Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem’s agenda remained the same.

“Secretary Noem unleashed ICE and CBP to arrest criminal illegal aliens including terrorists, gang members, murderers, pedophiles, and sexual predators,” McLaughlin said in [See ICE, A8]

Israel planning takeover of Gaza

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu says the escalation is necessary to destroy Hamas. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

Injured Stafford to join workout

Rams quarterback will train at Woodland Hills facility after receiving epidural for aggravated disc in back. **SPORTS, B10**

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JAYNE KAMIN-ONCEA Associated Press

COACH Sean McVay, left, hopes Matthew Stafford will get a month of work before the Rams face Texans.

Spine-tingling scares every day

The Universal Horror Unleashed attraction in Las Vegas will provide guests with Halloween frights year-round. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather
Sunny and warm.
L.A. Basin: 91/65. **B6**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

